

Customer Management in FlowDesk

Introduction to FlowDesk Customer Management

FlowDesk Customer Management helps support teams maintain organized customer profiles and connect customer information with support activity.

A customer profile provides a central record for information that helps agents identify and manage a customer, including their name, email address, company, tags, and custom fields.

Customer profiles can be associated with support tickets, allowing agents to understand who submitted a request and connect individual tickets with the relevant customer.

A typical customer management workflow is:

1. Create a customer profile.
2. Enter accurate customer information.
3. Add relevant tags and custom fields.
4. Associate the customer with support tickets.
5. Keep profile information updated as customer information changes.
6. Review the customer's support history when handling new requests.

[IMAGE: FlowDesk Customers dashboard showing a customer list with customer names, email addresses, companies, tags, and customer IDs]

Note: Keeping customer records accurate helps agents identify customers consistently and provides better context when handling support tickets.

Customer Profile Anatomy

Each FlowDesk customer profile may contain the following fields:

Field	Description	Example
customer_id	Unique identifier for the customer	CUS-2041
name	Customer's name	Alex Morgan
email	Customer's email address	alex@example.com
company	Company associated with the customer	Example Corp

Field	Description	Example
tags	Labels used to organize or segment customers	enterprise, priority
custom fields	Additional customer-specific information	customer_type: business

customer_id

`customer_id` uniquely identifies a customer profile within FlowDesk.

The identifier can be used to distinguish customers with similar names and to associate support tickets with the correct customer.

For example:

```
customer_id: CUS-2041
```

name

The `name` field identifies the customer.

Use the customer's actual name whenever it is available so agents can easily identify the person associated with a support request.

email

The `email` field stores the customer's email address.

Maintain accurate email information so agents can correctly identify the customer and use the available customer information when handling support requests.

company

The `company` field identifies the organization associated with the customer.

This is particularly useful when multiple customers belong to the same organization.

tags

Tags are labels that can be applied to customer profiles to help organize and segment customer accounts.

Examples include:

- enterprise
- priority
- new_customer
- trial

Tags should represent meaningful categories that are useful to your support team.

Custom fields

Custom fields allow teams to store additional customer-specific information beyond the standard profile fields.

For example, a team might define a custom field such as:

```
customer_type: business
```

Custom fields should contain information that is relevant to your team's customer management process.

Note: Custom fields extend the customer profile without changing the standard customer profile fields.

Creating a Customer Profile Manually

You can manually create a customer profile from the Customers section of FlowDesk.

Create a customer

1. Open **Customers** from the FlowDesk dashboard.
2. Select **Create Customer**.
3. Enter the customer's name.
4. Enter the customer's email address.
5. Enter the customer's company, if applicable.
6. Add relevant tags.
7. Enter relevant custom field values.
8. Review the information.
9. Save the customer profile.

[IMAGE: Create Customer form showing name, email, company, tags, and custom fields]

After the profile is created, FlowDesk assigns a `customer_id` to the customer.

A successful customer creation can also trigger the `customer.created` event when the appropriate automation or webhook configuration is in place.

Updating a Customer Profile

Customer information can change over time. Keep customer profiles updated whenever relevant information changes.

Update a customer

1. Open **Customers**.
2. Search for the customer you want to update.
3. Open the customer's profile.
4. Review the existing information.
5. Update the required fields.
6. Review the changes.
7. Save the customer profile.

[IMAGE: Customer profile page showing editable customer information, tags, and custom fields]

Common reasons to update a customer profile include:

- Correcting an incorrect name
- Updating an email address
- Updating the customer's company
- Adding or removing tags
- Updating custom field values

Best practice: Review the customer profile before making changes to avoid modifying the wrong customer's information.

Using Tags to Organize Customers

Tags provide a simple way to categorize customer accounts according to information that is useful to your support team.

Add a tag

1. Open the customer profile.
2. Locate the **Tags** section.
3. Add the appropriate tag.
4. Save the customer profile.

[IMAGE: Customer profile showing the Tags section with multiple customer tags]

Tags can be useful for grouping customers according to categories such as:

- Customer type
- Account segment
- Support importance
- Onboarding stage
- Other operational categories relevant to your support workflow

For example:

Customer:
Example Corp

Tags:
enterprise
priority

Use a consistent naming convention for tags across your workspace.

Remove an outdated tag

1. Open the customer profile.
2. Locate the outdated tag.
3. Remove the tag.
4. Save the customer profile.

Tip: Avoid creating multiple tags with nearly identical meanings. Consistent tagging makes customer segmentation easier to understand and maintain.

Using Custom Fields to Organize Customer Data

Custom fields provide additional structured information that can be stored on customer profiles.

Add or update a custom field

1. Open the customer profile.
2. Locate the **Custom Fields** section.
3. Enter or update the appropriate field value.
4. Review the value for accuracy.
5. Save the customer profile.

[IMAGE: Customer profile showing the Custom Fields section with example field names and values]

For example:

```
customer_type: business
```

Custom fields are useful when a piece of customer information needs to be stored consistently across multiple profiles.

Tags vs. custom fields

Use **tags** when you need simple labels for organizing or categorizing customers.

Use **custom fields** when you need to store a specific piece of customer information.

For example:

```
Tags:  
enterprise  
priority
```

```
Custom fields:  
customer_type: business
```

Best practice: Establish clear internal conventions for which information belongs in tags and which belongs in custom fields.

Linking Customer Profiles to Support Tickets

Customer profiles can be associated with support tickets through the ticket's `customer_id`.

This relationship allows agents to connect a support request with the customer who submitted it.

[IMAGE: Ticket creation form showing customer selection and the resulting customer profile association]

Associate a customer when creating a ticket

1. Open **Tickets**.
2. Select **Create Ticket**.
3. Select the appropriate customer.
4. Enter the ticket subject.
5. Enter the ticket description.
6. Select the ticket priority.
7. Save the ticket.

The ticket contains the customer's identifier:

```
customer_id: CUS-2041
```

This association allows agents to identify the customer connected to the ticket.

Verify the customer-ticket relationship

Before working on a customer request:

1. Open the ticket.
2. Review the associated customer.
3. Confirm the customer's name and other available profile information.
4. Verify that the ticket belongs to the correct customer.

Warning: Always verify the customer before updating customer information or handling sensitive support requests. Associating a ticket with the wrong customer can result in inaccurate customer records.

Managing Customer History and Past Interactions

Customer information becomes more useful when it is considered alongside the customer's support activity.

When a ticket is associated with a customer, agents can use the customer relationship to understand the context of the support request.

Review a customer's support activity

1. Open **Customers**.
2. Search for the customer.
3. Open the customer profile.
4. Review the customer's associated support activity.
5. Select relevant tickets to understand previous requests and their current status.

[IMAGE: Customer profile showing a customer's associated ticket history]

When reviewing previous tickets, pay attention to:

- Previous support requests
- Ticket subjects
- Ticket descriptions
- Ticket statuses
- Ticket priorities

- Assigned agents
- Ticket creation and update timestamps

This information can help agents avoid asking customers to repeat information that has already been provided in previous support requests.

Note: Customer history is based on customer-associated support activity. Keep ticket-to-customer associations accurate so agents can rely on the available context.

Best Practices for Clean and Accurate Customer Records

Maintaining customer data quality is a shared responsibility between agents and administrators.

Use consistent customer information

Enter customer information consistently across profiles.

For example:

- Use the customer's actual name.
- Enter valid email addresses.
- Use the company field consistently.
- Apply tags according to your team's established conventions.
- Use custom fields consistently.

Avoid duplicate customer profiles

Before creating a new customer, search for an existing profile that may already represent the customer.

Creating unnecessary duplicate profiles can make it difficult to determine which profile should be associated with a ticket.

Keep information current

Update customer information when you become aware that it has changed.

Review:

- Name
- Email
- Company
- Tags
- Custom fields

Keep tags meaningful

Use tags for categories that provide value to support operations.

Remove tags that are no longer relevant.

Use custom fields consistently

Define clear conventions for custom fields.

Avoid storing the same type of information under different custom field names across customer profiles.

Verify information before linking tickets

Always confirm that a ticket is associated with the correct customer before beginning support work.

Best practice: Treat `customer_id` as the primary identifier when distinguishing between customer profiles. Names and company names may not uniquely identify a customer.

Customer Data, Automations, and Webhooks

Customer profiles can interact with FlowDesk automation and webhook functionality.

Customer automation

FlowDesk automation supports event-based triggers. Customer creation can be used as an event that initiates an automated workflow.

For example:

```
Trigger:
customer.created

Action:
add_tag
```

The available automation actions include:

- `assign_ticket`
- `change_priority`
- `add_tag`
- `send_email`
- `send_webhook`

[IMAGE: FlowDesk automation builder showing customer.created as a trigger connected to an automation action]

Customer webhooks

FlowDesk supports the `customer.created` webhook event.

When this event is configured, FlowDesk sends the webhook request using HTTPS POST.

Supported webhook events include:

- `ticket.created`
- `ticket.updated`
- `ticket.resolved`
- `customer.created`

Failed webhook deliveries are retried up to 3 times.

Note: Webhooks are available on Pro and Enterprise plans. They are not available on the Free plan.

Customer data and automation considerations

When configuring customer-related automations:

1. Confirm that the selected trigger is appropriate.
2. Verify that the customer event occurs as expected.
3. Confirm that the intended action is configured correctly.
4. Check that any required feature is available on the workspace's subscription plan.
5. Verify the resulting customer or ticket data after the automation runs.

Troubleshooting Common Customer Profile Issues

I cannot find an existing customer

If a customer cannot be located:

1. Open **Customers**.
2. Search using available customer information.
3. Check the customer's name.
4. Check the customer's email address.
5. Review the company information if available.
6. Confirm that you are searching the correct customer records before creating a new profile.

Avoid creating a duplicate profile until you have confirmed that an existing profile does not already represent the customer.

I created a duplicate customer profile

If duplicate profiles exist, review both profiles carefully before making changes.

Compare:

- Customer information
- Email addresses
- Company information
- Tags
- Custom fields
- Associated tickets

Warning: Do not arbitrarily modify customer information when determining which profile should be used. Ensure that the correct customer profile is identified before updating ticket associations or customer information.

A ticket is associated with the wrong customer

Review the ticket's customer association and verify the intended customer profile.

1. Open the ticket.
2. Review the associated customer.
3. Confirm the customer's `customer_id`.
4. Select the correct customer if the ticket needs to be associated with a different profile.
5. Save the ticket.
6. Verify the updated association.

A customer's tag is missing

Open the customer profile and review the **Tags** section.

If the tag should be present:

1. Add the appropriate tag.
2. Check the tag spelling and naming convention.
3. Save the profile.
4. Confirm that the tag appears on the customer profile.

If the tag is added by automation, also review the automation configuration and its trigger.

A custom field contains incorrect information

1. Open the customer profile.
2. Locate the relevant custom field.
3. Verify the correct value.
4. Update the field.
5. Save the customer profile.
6. Confirm that the updated value is displayed.

A customer webhook was not received

If a configured `customer.created` webhook was not received:

1. Confirm that the workspace uses Pro or Enterprise.
2. Verify that the `customer.created` event is configured.
3. Confirm that the destination accepts HTTPS POST requests.
4. Check the receiving system for incoming requests.
5. Remember that FlowDesk retries failed webhook deliveries up to 3 times.

A customer automation did not run

Review the automation configuration:

1. Confirm that `customer.created` or the intended trigger is configured.
2. Verify that the expected customer event occurred.
3. Confirm that the automation action is configured correctly.
4. Check whether the action depends on a feature available on the workspace plan.
5. Review the resulting customer data.

Recommended Customer Management Workflow

Use the following workflow to maintain reliable customer records:

1. **Search first** — Check whether a customer profile already exists.
2. **Create when necessary** — Create a new profile only when an appropriate existing profile cannot be found.
3. **Enter accurate information** — Provide the customer's name, email, company, tags, and applicable custom fields.
4. **Verify the profile** — Review the information before saving.
5. **Link support tickets** — Associate tickets with the correct `customer_id`.
6. **Keep information updated** — Update profile data when customer information changes.
7. **Maintain segmentation** — Keep tags and custom fields consistent.
8. **Review support history** — Use associated tickets to understand previous customer requests.
9. **Monitor automations** — Verify that customer-related automation behaves as expected.

10. **Maintain data quality** — Regularly identify inaccurate, outdated, or inconsistent customer information.

Best practice: Accurate customer records provide a reliable foundation for ticket management, automation, and customer support operations across FlowDesk.